

Justices to weigh ‘digital dragnet’ searches

Law enforcement’s use of cellphone location tracking concerns privacy advocates.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — A man carrying a gun and a cellphone entered a federal credit union in a small town in central Virginia in May 2019 and demanded cash.

He left with \$195,000 in a bag and no clue to his identity. But his smartphone was keeping track of him.

What happened next could yield a landmark ruling from the Supreme Court on the 4th Amendment and its restrictions against “unreasonable searches.” The court will hear arguments on the issue on Monday.

Typically, police use tips or leads to find suspects, then seek a search warrant from a judge to enter a house or other private area to seize the evidence that can prove a crime.

Civil libertarians say the new “digital dragnets” work in reverse.

“It’s grab the data and search first. Suspicion later. That’s opposite of how our system has worked, and it’s really dangerous,” said Jake Laperruque, an attorney for the Center for Democracy & Technology.

But these new data scans can be effective in finding criminals.

Lacking leads in the Virginia bank robbery, a police detective turned to what one judge in the case called a “groundbreaking investigative tool ... enabling the relentless collection of eerily precise location data.”

Cellphones can be tracked through towers, and Google stored this location history data for hundreds of millions of users.

The detective sent Google a demand for information known as a “geofence warrant,” referring to a virtual fence around a particular geographic area at a specific time.

The officer sought phones that were within 150 yards of the bank during the hour of the robbery. He used that data to locate Okello Chatrte, then obtained a search warrant of his home, where the cash and the hold-up notes were found.

Chatrte entered a conditional guilty plea, but the Supreme Court will hear his appeal next week.

The justices agreed to decide whether geofence warrants violate the 4th Amendment.

The outcome may go beyond location tracking. At [See Searches, A8]



ATTA KENARE AFP/Getty Images

TRUMP EXTENDS CEASEFIRE

An Iranian woman walks past a patriotic mural in Tehran. On Tuesday, President Trump extended the ceasefire with Iran a day before it was set to expire and as last-minute talks looked uncertain. **WORLD, A3**

Will Apple CEO make bolder bets?

New leader’s challenge is to advance AI, build another category-defining product

By Queenie Wong and Niles Christopher



ADAM GRAY Bloomberg

JOHN TERNUS, Tim Cook’s successor, has big shoes to fill as the firm begins a new era, analysts say.

that people around the world will buy, it must also innovate and embrace transition to maintain its leadership position in consumer tech in a world increasingly powered by artificial intelligence.

The company has long been defined by distinct eras of leadership, including Jobs’ product-driven revolution and Cook’s operational discipline and services focus. Ternus is inheriting a massive business, finely tuned to delight die-hard fans. He will have to decide whether the next stage of growth will be more of the same or a return to bolder bets, analysts say.

“He must resist the temptation of incrementalism that has plagued Apple of late,” said Dipanjan Chatterjee, vice president and principal analyst at Forrester. “As Ternus assumes the helm, he must define Apple’s future as ferociously as [See Apple, A10]

LAUSD looks to expand campus day care

Adding programs for tots would aid families — and fortify district’s enrollment pipeline.

By KATE SEQUEIRA

LAUSD is seeking to double its infant care centers and expand early education programs for toddlers, a plan that aims to push the district deeper into the child-care industry, provide affordable day care and eventually bolster dwindling district enrollment.

A resolution that was unanimously approved Tuesday by the Board of Education calls for reopening several shuttered early education centers, placing more preschool classrooms on elementary campuses and expanding the district’s relationship with local child-care providers.

“We know early learning is transformative and very beneficial for the students that we serve in Los Angeles,” said board member Kelly Gonez, who introduced the resolution. “We know that there are still gaps in terms of access to programs and care for our families in Los Angeles, and that this is a really significant expense for families.”

One goal of the ambitious plan could bring some relief to Los Angeles families that often face a heavy financial burden paying for care before a child is eligible to enter the public school system.

The median cost for full-time care for an infant in L.A. County was \$1,209 a month at a family child-care home [See LAUSD, A8]

His campaign message: This is the ‘worst-run state’

By Jenny Jarvie

Steve Hilton is a former Fox News host who has unexpectedly emerged as a leading candidate in the race for governor with a message that California is a failed state in need of radical reform.

But his sudden rise in California politics comes a decade and a half after he pitched the U.K. Conservative Party with a very different idea: Britain could learn a lot from the Golden State.

Back in 2010, when Hilton was a top strategist during David Cameron’s rise to power as Conservative prime minister, he looked to Silicon Valley’s high-charged ethos of techno-optimism and green innovation for inspiration as he sought to revitalize the ailing Conservative Party and the U.K.

Splitting his time between London and the Bay Area — his wife worked for Google — Hilton was instrumental in getting California companies to invest in the U.K. and persuading Google to open its first wholly owned and designed building outside the U.S. in London. So infatuated was he with California that one British political commentator dubbed the Cameron administration’s philosophy “Thatcherism on a surfboard.”

But Hilton is now utterly unsparing in his criticism of California.

After moving to the Bay Area full time, teaching at Stanford University and hosting Fox News’ “The Next Revolution,” Hilton is running as a Republican on a platform of [See Hilton, A7]



MARCO UGARTE Associated Press

THE ASSAILANT went to the pyramid with literature about the Columbine massacre, authorities said.

Mexico gunman was obsessed with shootings in U.S.

One person died and 13 were wounded in Monday’s attack at Teotihuacán pyramid.

By KATE LINTHICUM AND PATRICK J. McDONNELL

MEXICO CITY — The assailant who opened fire on tourists at one of Mexico’s signature archaeological sites — leaving a Canadian woman dead and 13 other foreign visitors injured, including six U.S. citizens — was a copycat who admired mass shooters and meticulously planned the attack, Mexican authorities said Tuesday.

The shooting Monday triggered new fears about Mexico’s vital tourist industry at a pivotal moment: The country is gearing up to host matches in June and July during the World Cup, perhaps the globe’s premier sporting event.

Authorities have insisted that police have imple-

mented an extensive World Cup security regimen to protect both soccer venues and people. On Monday, officials described the gunfire at the archaeological site of Teotihuacán as the work of a single disturbed man who was obsessed with the Columbine High School massacre in Colorado.

“Everything indicates that this person had traits of psychological problems, and was influenced by episodes that have occurred” outside Mexico, said President Claudia Sheinbaum at her morning news conference.

The official comments came as survivors, including a young couple from Chicago, described frantic efforts to escape the gunman from the 140-foot-tall pyramid.

The assailant, identified as Julio César Jasso Ramírez, 27, shot himself dead as police and troops approached him near the top of the pyramid, authorities said.

After Monday’s attack, [See Gunman, A4]

Festival founder incurs punks’ wrath

An O.C. promoter donated \$225 to Trump. Angry bands revolted and bolted.

By AUGUST BROWN

Cameron Collins was sick of Joe Biden.

The owner of concert promoter Brew Ha Ha Productions describes himself as a libertarian-leaning conservative who built his career in San Juan Capistrano. He’d kept his personal politics out of his popular SoCal events, like the ska fest OC Super Show and the nationally touring Punk in the Park fest, a staple for bands like Bad Religion and Pennywise.

On May 30, 2024, Collins

felt dismayed that then-President Biden had pursued reelection. In a fit of anger, he donated \$225 to Donald Trump’s campaign.

“It was just an impulsive thing,” Collins said. “Biden had said he was going to run again. I was like, nope. He’d said he wasn’t. It was more about that than anything. I don’t post anything political or talk about anything politically. I’ve never donated to anything like that before.”

That donation proved fateful. After a small punk label discovered and decried Collins’ donation, the scene turned on him. Influential bands pulled out of his festivals or said they wouldn’t return.

On Feb. 27, Collins canceled every Punk in the Park date for 2026.

[See Punk, A11]

Trump Fed pick avows independence

Kevin Warsh tells a Senate panel the president hasn’t pressed him on interest rates. **NATION, A6**

Pushing back on honking citation

A Utah man says ticket he got at a “No Kings” rally was political. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

A police surge against burglars

LAPD deploys road, air, horseback patrols in the Valley after nine break-ins. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Periods of sunshine. L.A. Basin: 73/57. **B6**

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